

Skills

Administering Intramuscular Injections

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Prepared medication for only one patient at a time.	☐	☐	☐	
Used aseptic technique. Avoided distractions and interruptions.	☐	☐	☐	
Checked the medication label twice against the order in the medication administration record. Made sure to check the medication expiration date when retrieving the medication.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Took the medication to the patient at the correct time following the six rights of medication safety, according to agency's policy. Gave time-critical medications at the exact time specified in the order.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for the patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers according to agency policy. Compared this information to the MAR or medical record. Asked the patient if he or she had any allergies.	☐	☐	☐	
Accessed the electronic MAR again. At the patient's bedside, again compared the MAR or computer printout with the names of the medications on the medication labels and with the patient's name.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment. Discussed the purpose of each medication with the patient, including its action and possible adverse effects. Allowed the patient to ask questions. Told the patient that the injection may cause a slight stinging or burning sensation.	☐	☐	☐	

Selected an appropriate injection site. Noted the integrity and size of the patient's muscle. Palpated for tenderness or hardness, and avoided such areas. If the patient received frequent injections, rotated the site selection.

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Inspected the area for bruising, inflammation, or edema. If the skin was bruised or showed signs of infection, used a different site.

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Helped the patient into a comfortable position, according to the site being used. Exposed only that portion of the body.

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Applied clean gloves. Used anatomical landmarks to find the site again. Avoided the dorsogluteal site because of proximity to the sciatic nerve.

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For a ventrogluteal injection:

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1. Placed the heel of the hand over the greater trochanter of the patient's hip with the wrist almost perpendicular to the femur.
2. Pointed the thumb toward the patient's groin.
3. Pointed the index finger to the anterior superior iliac spine.
4. Extended the middle finger back along the iliac crest toward the buttocks.
5. Located the injection site in the center of the triangle.
6. Marked the site with an unopened alcohol wipe.

Cleansed the site with an antiseptic swab.

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Held a gauze pad between the third and fourth fingers of nondominant hand.

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Removed the needle cap or protective sheath.

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Held the syringe between the thumb and forefinger of dominant hand.

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Reminded patient to try and relax.

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Administered the injection:

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1. Positioned the ulnar side of nondominant hand just below the injection site, and pulled the patient's skin laterally 2.5 to 3.5 cm. Held this position until needle was inserted.
2. If the patient had little muscle mass, grasped the body of the muscle between thumb and forefinger.
3. With your dominant hand, injected the needle quickly into the muscle at a 90-degree angle using a steady and smooth motion.
4. After the needle had pierced the muscle, continued to pull the skin taught with nondominant hand. Stabilized the syringe by grasping the lower end of the barrel with the fingers of nondominant hand as they were resting on the patient.
5. If aspiration was performed and blood appeared in the syringe, removed the needle and discarded the medication, then obtained a new syringe and tried again.

6. Injected the medication.
7. Waited 10 seconds, and then quickly, smoothly, and steadily withdrew the needle. Engaged the needle safety sheath. Released the skin, and applied a dry cotton ball or gauze pad with light pressure for several seconds over the site.

Applied gentle pressure. Did not massage the site. Applied a bandage to the injection site if needed. ☐ ☐ ☐

Discarded the needle and its attached syringe in a puncture-proof, leak-proof container. ☐ ☐ ☐

Helped the patient into a comfortable position. Disposed of used gauze. Removed gloves, and performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Documented the injection immediately in the MAR. Included the medication name, the dosage given, and the site in which it was injected. ☐ ☐ ☐

Stayed with the patient for several minutes, observing for any allergic reaction. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed toiletries and personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed the call light within easy reach, and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised the appropriate number of side rails and lowered the bed to the lowest position. ☐ ☐ ☐

Left the patient's room tidy. ☐ ☐ ☐

Returned to the patient's room in 15 to 30 minutes to see if he or she had had any acute reaction at the injection site. ☐ ☐ ☐

Learner:	_____	Signature:	_____
Evaluator:	_____	Signature:	_____
Date:	_____		